The New Kingdom and the Religious Reforms

The rise of Ahmose I began what is referred to as the New Kingdom Period (1,570 – 1,069 BCE). Egypt, now reunited once more, began experiencing a period of social and economic stability. It is at this point we see the introduction of the title pharaoh. Prior to Ahmose I, rulers were referred to as kings. Several of the iconic temples and structures around Thebes date from this time. These include Abu Simbel, the Karnak Temple, the Luxor Temple and the Valley of the Kings and Queens. Tuthmosis I was able to expand the borders to the Euphrates River, Syria and Nubia. Queen Hatshepsut was the first female pharaoh and ruled after him. She increased the country's trading networks to various other lands including that of Punt. She ruled for 22 years peacefully and the country became very wealthy. After her, Tuthmosis II tried to wipe her from all Egyptian records but was unsuccessful.

Tuthmosis III continued her policies but scholars believe he did not want other women to rule the country because he saw only men to be the rightful rulers. Many of her cartouches were destroyed in order to remove her mark on history. When he died in 1,425 BCE, the country had increased in power and prestige. Various types of beer were created as people enjoyed their time. Healthcare practices improved and beautiful baths were established as a means of leisure and enjoyment. Women's healthcare and contraception practices were recorded within the Kahun Gynecological Papyrus, which was written around 1,800 BCE and was used by Egyptian physicians. The Egyptians had access to surgeons and dentists who were gifted with some of the greatest skills to be found in the ancient world.

Amenhotep IV took the throne in 1,353 BCE and it wasn't long before he renamed himself Akhenaten, which translates to *the living spirit of Aten*. This name change was a reflection of his devout belief in the singular god Aten. In the past, Egypt had worshipped a pantheon of deities, with Osiris, Ptah, Isis, Amunand and Hathor being the most popular amongst them. Akhenaten's popularity had developed to such an extent that the priests were incredibly wealthy and held almost as much power as the pharaoh himself. Akhenaten and his wife Nefertiti turned their backs on the old